

SMARTPHONES

UNDER 15K

We guide you through purchase decisions in perhaps the most popular phone category

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ZTE V5

Some people care about brand value of their devices, which we don't really endorse, but we guess Motorola is the biggest "name" in this segment. All phones have a one year warranty, but after sales service is still important. Micromax service centers are a lot easier to find than Lava's, Karbonn's or others. Though Xiaomi service centers are

The new battleground for smartphones is the under ₹15k segment. There are more options, but with more choices comes more confusion.

The Xiaomi Mi3 is the best in class in this segment, but it's difficult to get a hold of.

The performance offered in this category is almost at par with flagship models from just a few years ago. The new Moto G continues Motorola's tradition of inexpensive devices that perform very well.



Xiaomi Mi3

If you can't get the Mi3, the next best is the Micromax Canvas Nitro, which boasts a 1.7 Ghz octa-core SoC and 2 GB of RAM at the same ₹12,999 price tag as the new Moto G.

Usually budget devices compromise on build quality, but that's not really true anymore. The Xiaomi Redmi 1S is one of the least expensive, yet high performing devices in the market, which doesn't compro-

mise on quality. Xiaomi chose the scratch resistant Dragontrail glass over the more powerful Gorilla Glass, but the Moto E does use Gorilla Glass 3 – at just a ₹1,000 price difference.

Cameras and displays have also seen drastic improvements. There are a bunch of devices sporting a Sony EXMOR sensor that cost less than ₹15k. The best in class again is the Mi3,

while the ZTE V5 and Canvas Nitro both offer good 13 MP cameras with HD screens as well. For under ₹10k the Xiaomi Redmi 1S boasts of the best camera and display. These companies use displays made by Sharp, who also make the iPhone's display.



Micromax Canvas Nitro



Xiaomi Redmi 1S

few and far between, we hear they offer solutions in just two hours.

The Chinese and Indian brands may have been known for bad service before, but that's no longer the case. Affordable smartphones are no longer a compromise. **[4]**



Motorola Moto G

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